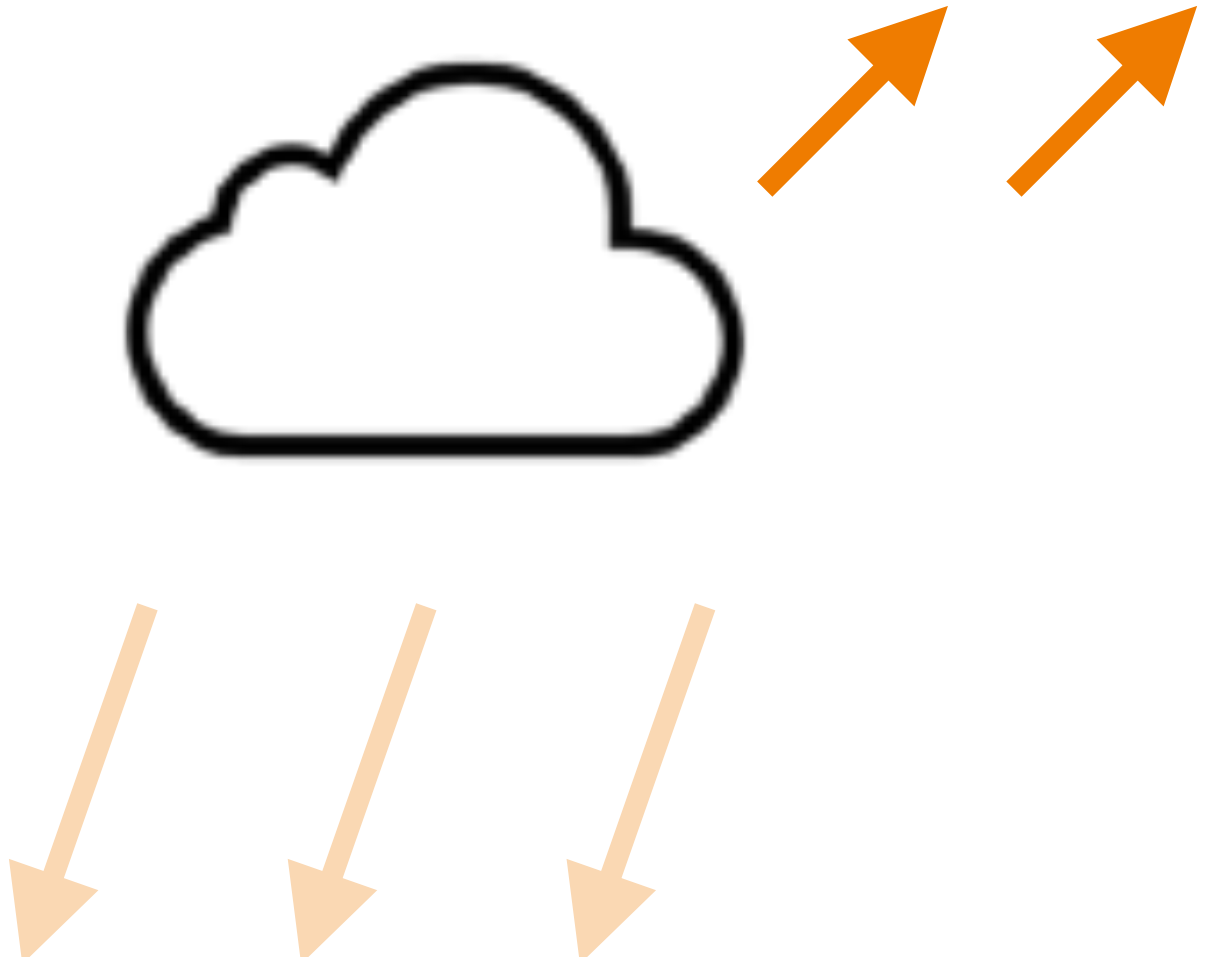
Clouds and radiation

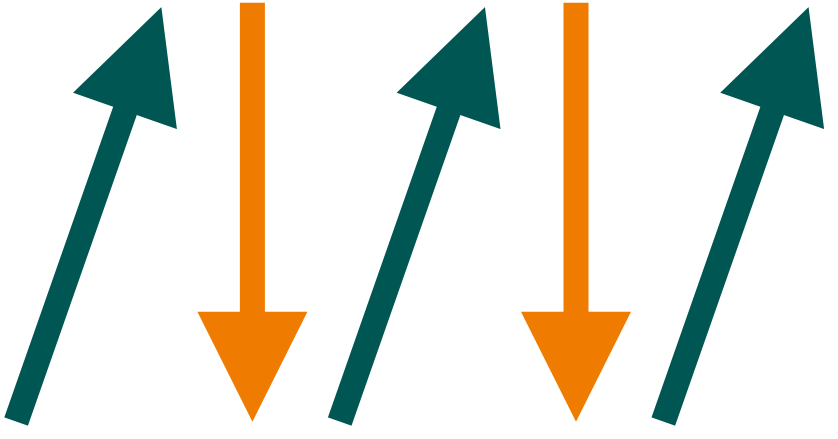
8

incoming SW radiation

clouds reflect
some of this

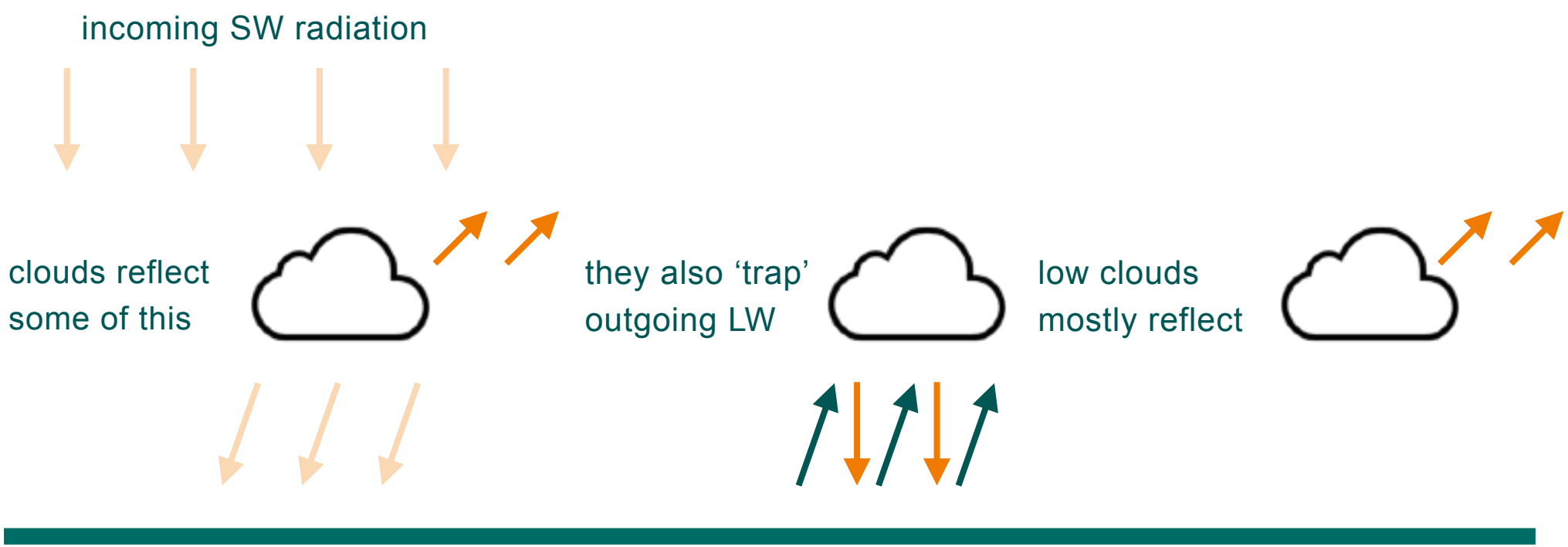


they also ‘trap’ outgoing LW

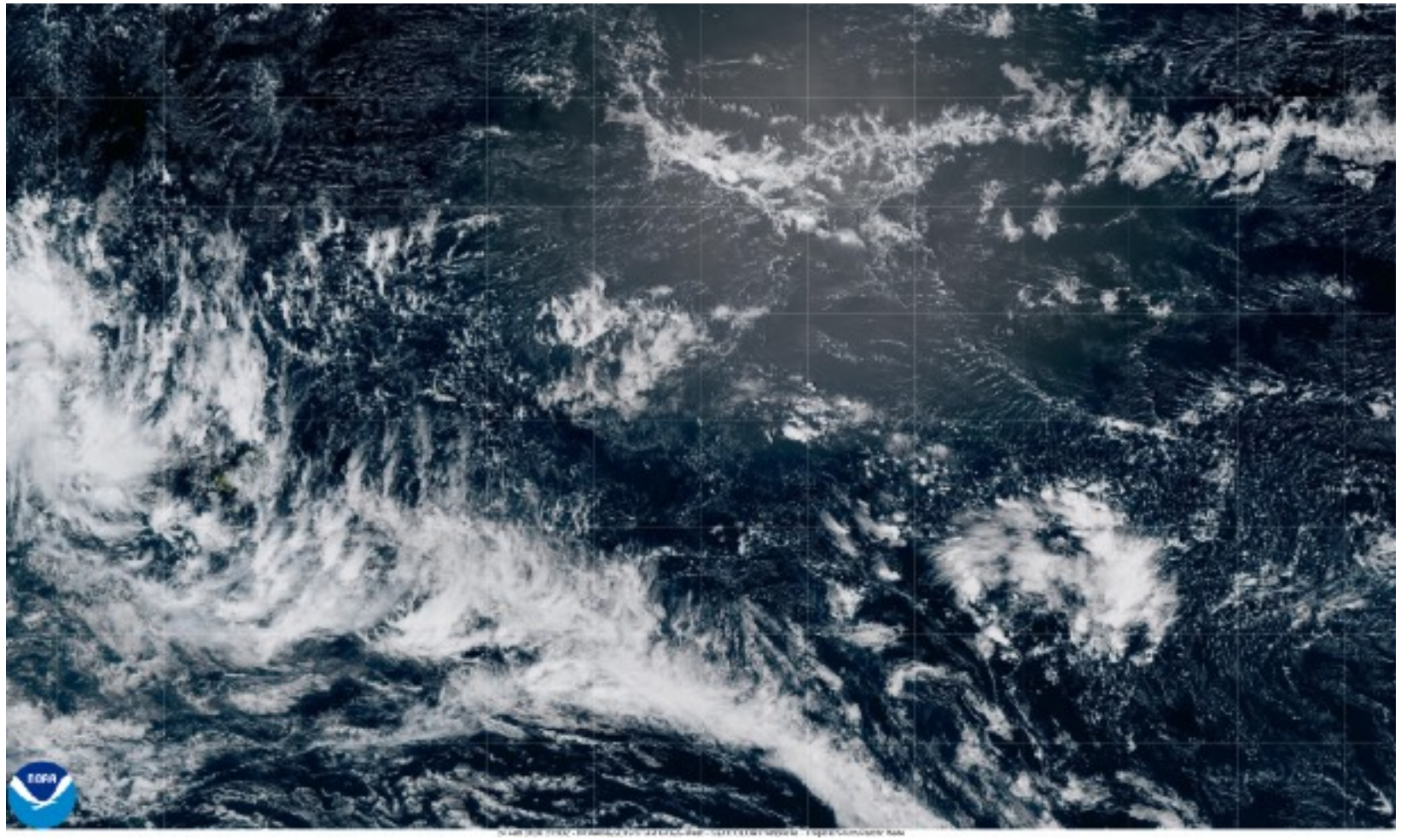


low clouds
mostly reflect

Clouds and radiation



Radiative effect of cloud *albedo* is especially important over ocean!



NASA GOES satellite image of tropical south Pacific (2026-02-24)